

Overrated and Underrated Business Books

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Executive Summary

Brandon Carter gives quick verdicts on four classic business books, arguing that reputation and marketing have distorted how each is perceived — two are overrated for what they leave out, two underrated for what critics miss.

Contents

-  Think and Grow Rich — Overrated
- 😞 The Secret — Overrated
- 💰 Rich Dad, Poor Dad — Underrated
- ⌚ The 4-Hour Workweek — Underrated

Think and Grow Rich — Overrated [0:00](#)

- Verdict: **Overrated** — but not because it's a bad book
 - The reason is simply that Napoleon Hill wrote a better book
 - Brandon's recommended alternative: *Outwitting the Devil* by Napoleon Hill
 - He enjoyed Think and Grow Rich until he read Outwitting the Devil
 - His reaction: "Oh, this is the real right here"

😞 The Secret — Overrated [0:10](#)

- Verdict: **Overrated** — not because it's entirely wrong, but because it omits a critical element
 - Legend has it the author based the book on *The Science of Getting Rich* by **Wallace D. Wattles**
 - In Wattles' original book, a key instruction appears **over 50 times**, written in all caps:
 - "Do all that can be done each day" — meaning work at full capacity every single day
 - The Secret barely mentions this emphasis on action and hard work
 - Brandon's view: leaving out that core message makes the book misleading about how goals are actually achieved

Rich Dad, Poor Dad — Underrated [0:47](#)

- Verdict: **Underrated** — despite widespread criticism of author Robert Kiyosaki
 - Brandon acknowledges Kiyosaki "be talking crazy sometimes — a lot of the time, most of the time"

- Still, the book fundamentally changed how he thinks about money
- He read it at **age 17**, and says it had a huge positive impact on him
- His point: the core ideas in the book are valuable regardless of the author's public behavior

The 4-Hour Workweek — Underrated 1:09

- Verdict: **Underrated** — critics are reacting to the marketing, not the actual content
 - The title and marketing implied you only need to work 4 hours a week to reach your goals
 - Brandon's read of the real message: get a full week's worth of work done *in* 4 hours — it's about efficiency, not minimal effort
 - "That didn't mean you only have to work 4 hours a week. It's just basically getting more done with your time."
 - Personal impact: the book helped him **launch his career as an entrepreneur**